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Contact: Kevin Conway
Associate Director of University Communication
(414) 288-4745 – office
(414) 202-9329 – mobile
kevin.m.conway@marquette.edu

Oct. 28, 2026

This release is also available online.

Marquette Law School Poll finds Crowley at 51%, Tiffany 44% among likely voters in final survey before Nov. 3 election

Crowley 47%, Tiffany 44% among registered voters as Democrats maintain enthusiasm and projected turnout advantage

Also:

- Crowley seen as doing more on healthcare costs, education, and data centers; Tiffany as doing more on taxes
- 60% prefer governor and legislature of the same party, 38% favor divided government
- Trump job approval declines to 37%; disapproval at 61%
- Opinion remains sour on economy, inflation, and gas and grocery prices
- First Marquette Law School Poll set of sports questions find lots of fans of the Packers (54%) and Brewers (49%), with more than 75% at least a casual fan of each

Please note: Complete Poll results and methodology information can be found online at law.marquette.edu/poll

MILWAUKEE — A new Marquette Law School Poll survey of Wisconsin finds that, among those who describe themselves as certain to vote for governor on or before Nov. 3, Democrat David Crowley is the choice of 51% and Republican Tom Tiffany the choice of 44%, with 4% undecided. Among all registered voters, Crowley is the choice of 47% and Tiffany is supported by 44%, with 9% undecided. In September, Crowley had 49% and Tiffany 46% of likely voters, and, among registered voters, Crowley had 46% and Tiffany 45%.

Crowley leads with those who are absolutely certain they will vote or have already done so (the group classified as “likely voters”), while Tiffany leads among those who say they are

not certain but very likely to vote, as well as among those who say they may not or won't vote.

The results for all registered voters include everyone in the survey, regardless of likelihood of voting. If the electorate expands from those most likely to vote to include those less than certain to vote, the race tightens. Higher turnout than currently expected results in a closer race. This is shown in Table 1. (All results in the tables are stated as percentages.)

Table 1: Vote for governor, by likelihood of voting

Among registered voters

Likelihood of voting	Vote choice		
	Tom Tiffany	David Crowley	Haven't decided
October 2026			
Among all registered voters	44	47	9
Absolutely certain + already voted (= 'likely voters')	44	51	4
Very likely but not certain	42	30	28
May not/will not vote	45	35	20
September 2026			
Among all registered voters	45	46	9
Absolutely certain + already voted (= 'likely voters')	46	49	5
Very likely but not certain	47	32	21
May not/will not vote	36	37	26

Marquette Law School Poll, Wisconsin surveys, Oct. 14-22, 2026, and Sept. 16-23, 2026

Question: If the election for governor were held today between (Tom Tiffany, the Republican), and (David Crowley, the Democrat), would you vote for (Tom Tiffany) or for (David Crowley) or haven't you decided?

Question: What are the chances that you will vote in the November 2026 elections for governor, Congress and other offices-- are you absolutely certain to vote, very likely to vote, are the chances 50-50, or don't you think you will vote, or have you already voted by absentee ballot?

The survey was conducted Oct. 14-22, 2026, interviewing 818 Wisconsin registered voters, with a margin of error of +/-4.3 points for each candidate's percentage. For likely voters, the sample size is 668 with a margin of error of +/-4.7 points for each candidate's percentage.

The margin of error for the difference between the two candidates is thus twice the margin of error for the individual percentages. The leads among both likely voters and registered voters here are within the margin of error for the difference.

In September, Crowley had a one-point advantage among registered voters, 46% to 45%. In October his support rose by one point and Tiffany's declined by one point, resulting in a 3-point edge. Among likely voters in September, Crowley had 49% and Tiffany 46%, with Crowley gaining 2 points and Tiffany losing 2 points in October, for a net gain of 4 points, to a 7-point lead in October.

More detail about these shifts is seen by party identification. Among likely voters, Republican support for Tiffany slipped from 95% in September to 92% in October, while Democratic support for Crowley rose from 96% to 98%. There are very few undecided voters among partisans.

Among independents, Crowley support increased from 44% in September to 56% in October, while Tiffany support grew from 18% to 26%. Those independents who were undecided declined from 38% in September to 18% in October, still leaving almost one-in-five independents yet to choose a candidate.

Among registered voters, Republican support for Tiffany slipped 3 points as Democratic support for Crowley was unchanged. Tiffany gained 6 points with independents and Crowley gained 4 points, but a large percentage of independents remain undecided among registered voters. These results are shown in Table 2.

Table 2: Vote for governor, by party identification

Among likely voters and registered voters

Party ID	Vote choice		
	Tom Tiffany	David Crowley	Haven't decided
October 2026 — Likely voters			
Among all likely voters	44	51	4
Republican	92	4	3
Independent	26	56	18
Democrat	0	98	2
October 2026 — Registered voters			
Among all registered voters	44	47	9
Republican	89	4	7
Independent	25	44	32
Democrat	1	95	4
September 2026 — Likely voters			
Among all likely voters	46	49	5
Republican	95	4	2
Independent	18	44	38
Democrat	3	96	1
September 2026 — Registered voters			
Among all registered voters	45	46	9
Republican	92	3	5
Independent	19	40	41
Democrat	2	95	3

Marquette Law School Poll, Wisconsin surveys, Oct. 14-22, 2026, and Sept. 16-23, 2026

Question: If the election for governor were held today between (Tom Tiffany, the Republican), and (David Crowley, the Democrat), would you vote for (Tom Tiffany) or for (David Crowley) or haven't you decided?

Among likely voters, the legislative vote closely mirrors the vote for governor, with 51% saying they will vote for the Democratic legislative candidate and 44% for the Republican. Among registered voters, 47% support the Democrat and 45% favor the Republican, as shown in Table 3.

Table 3: Vote for the state legislature, by party identification

Among likely voters and registered voters

Party ID	Vote choice		
	Republican candidate	Democratic candidate	Haven't decided
October 2026 — Likely voters			
Among all likely voters	44	51	5
Republican	92	3	5
Independent	22	62	17
Democrat	0	98	2
October 2026 — Registered voters			
Among all registered voters	45	47	8
Republican	90	2	7
Independent	27	45	28
Democrat	1	96	3
September 2026 — Likely voters			
Among all likely voters	45	48	7
Republican	92	2	5
Independent	26	38	35
Democrat	1	96	3
September 2026 — Registered voters			
Among all registered voters	44	45	10
Republican	91	2	7
Independent	21	35	43
Democrat	1	95	4

Marquette Law School Poll, Wisconsin surveys, Oct. 14-22, 2026, and Sept. 16-23, 2026

Question: If the election for the Wisconsin state legislature were held today, would you vote for the (Republican) candidate in your district or the (Democratic) candidate in your district?

Majorities of both Republican and Democratic voters say they prefer to have the governor and legislature of the same party, rather than have divided government. Among all registered voters, 60% prefer unified control and 38% favor divided government. Among Republicans, 59% prefer unified control, as do 65% of Democrats. Independents are evenly divided on this question, with 49% in favor of one-party control and 49% in favor of divided control. This is shown in Table 4.

Table 4: Same-party or divided state government, by party identification

Among registered voters

Party ID	Which is better	
	Governor and legislature of same party	Governor and legislature of different parties
Among all registered voters	60	38
Republican	59	39
Independent	49	49
Democrat	65	34

Marquette Law School Poll, Wisconsin survey, Oct. 14-22, 2026

Question: Which is better, (a governor and legislature of the same party) or (a governor and legislature of different parties)?

Turnout and enthusiasm

Democrats retain an advantage in likelihood of voting, with 84% saying they are certain to vote or have already done so, while 77% of Republicans say the same. That is a 1-point decrease since September for each party. Sixty-four percent of independents are certain they will vote, a 3-point increase. The results are shown in Table 5.

Table 5: Likelihood of voting, by party identification

Among registered voters

Party ID	Likelihood of voting			
	Absolutely certain	Very likely	50-50	Will not vote
October 2026				
Among all registered voters	78	12	8	2
Republican	77	12	8	3
Independent	64	24	11	1
Democrat	84	9	6	1
September 2026				
Among all registered voters	79	13	7	2
Republican	78	14	6	1
Independent	61	23	10	5
Democrat	85	8	6	1

Marquette Law School Poll, Wisconsin surveys, Oct. 14-22, 2026, and Sept. 16-23, 2026

Question: What are the chances that you will vote in the November 2026 elections for governor, Congress and other offices-- are you absolutely certain to vote, very likely to vote, are the chances 50-50, or don't you think you will vote, or have you already voted by absentee ballot?

Note: "Absolutely certain" includes those who have already voted

Enthusiasm for voting also favors the Democrats by 8 percentage points in October, the same as in September. Independents are considerably less enthusiastic about voting than are partisans, as shown in Table 6.

Table 6: Enthusiasm about voting, by party identification

Among registered voters

Party ID	Enthusiasm			
	Very enthusiastic	Somewhat enthusiastic	Not too enthusiastic	Not at all enthusiastic
October 2026				
Among all registered voters	51	25	18	6
Republican	49	25	18	7
Independent	35	26	28	11
Democrat	57	25	15	3
September 2026				
Among all registered voters	46	31	18	4
Republican	46	32	19	3
Independent	23	30	30	17
Democrat	54	31	14	1

Marquette Law School Poll, Wisconsin surveys, Oct. 14-22, 2026, and Sept. 16-23, 2026

Question: How enthusiastic are you about voting in the November 2026 elections for governor, Congress and other offices? Would you say you are very, somewhat, not too, or not at all enthusiastic?

Divisions within parties

Among Republican likely voters, 82% approve of the way President Donald Trump is doing his job as president, while 17% disapprove. Among Republican registered voters, 75% approve and 23% disapprove. Those Republicans who approve of Trump's job performance are virtually unanimous in support of Tiffany. Among those who disapprove of Trump, Tiffany's support slips, Crowley's support rises, and the share who are undecided is notably higher in October than in September. Too few independents or Democrats approve of Trump to allow a similar comparison among those groups.

In October among likely voters, Tiffany wins 59% of Republicans who disapprove of Trump, Crowley receives 25%, and 16% are undecided. Among registered Republicans who disapprove, Tiffany gets 61%, Crowley 17%, and 22% are undecided. While this relatively large number of undecideds is a potential source for some future gains for Tiffany, in September Tiffany did better among Trump-disapprovers and there were fewer who were undecided, as shown in Table 7.

Table 7: Vote for governor, by Trump approval among Republicans

Among Republicans

Trump approval	Vote Choice		
	Tom Tiffany	David Crowley	Haven't decided
October 2026--Likely voters			
Approve	99	0	1
Disapprove	59	25	16
October 2026--Registered voters			
Approve	98	0	2
Disapprove	61	17	22
September 2026--Likely voters			
Approve	99	0	1
Disapprove	71	24	5
September 2026--Registered voters			
Approve	96	0	4
Disapprove	77	14	9

Marquette Law School Poll, Wisconsin surveys, Oct. 14-22, 2026, and Sept. 16-23, 2026

Question: If the election for governor were held today between (Tom Tiffany, the Republican), and (David Crowley, the Democrat), would you vote for (Tom Tiffany) or for (David Crowley) or haven't you decided?

Question: Overall, do you approve or disapprove of the way Donald Trump is handling his job as president?

Among Republican likely voters, 80% have a favorable view of the MAGA movement; among Democratic likely voters, 64% are favorable to democratic socialists. As with Trump approval, Republicans unfavorable to MAGA are less supportive of Tiffany than are pro-MAGA Republicans, 99% of whom support Tiffany. Among Democrats, favorability to democratic socialists is only modestly related to vote for Crowley, with more than 90% of both groups of Democrats (both favorable and unfavorable to democratic socialists) backing him. These results are shown in Table 8.

Table 8: Vote for governor, by party identification and MAGA/Dem Socialist

Among likely voters

Party ID	Vote choice		
	Tom Tiffany	David Crowley	Haven't decided
October 2026			
Among likely voters	44	51	4
Republican, fav MAGA	99	0	1
Republican, non-MAGA	64	22	14
Independent	26	56	18
Democrat, non-dem socialist	1	93	6
Democrat, fav dem socialist	0	100	0
September 2026			
Among likely voters	46	49	5
Republican, fav MAGA	99	0	0
Republican, non-MAGA	73	20	7
Independent	18	44	38
Democrat, non-dem socialist	4	92	4
Democrat, fav dem socialist	2	98	0

Marquette Law School Poll, Wisconsin surveys, Oct. 14-22, 2026, and Sept. 16-23, 2026

Question: If the election for governor were held today between (Tom Tiffany, the Republican), and (David Crowley, the Democrat), would you vote for (Tom Tiffany) or for (David Crowley) or haven't you decided?

Note: Republicans are split by favorability to the MAGA movement, Democrats by favorability to democratic socialists.

Views of candidates

Crowley's favorability improved from 31% in September to 37% in October, while his unfavorable rating remained unchanged at 44%, yielding a net favorability of -7. That has improved from -13 points in September. Tiffany's favorable rating rose 1 point and unfavorable rose 5 points, giving a net favorability of -10 points.

The candidates for attorney general remain far less well known than the gubernatorial candidates. Incumbent Democrat Josh Kaul is seen favorably by 23% and unfavorably by 20%, with 56% unable to say. For Republican Eric Toney, 13% are favorable and 13% unfavorable, with 72% lacking an opinion. All these ratings are shown in Table 9.

Table 9: Favorability of gubernatorial and attorney general candidates

Among registered voters

Candidate	Name ID	Net Fav	Favorable	Unfavorable	Haven't heard enough
October 2026					
David Crowley	81	-7	37	44	18
Tom Tiffany	90	-10	40	50	10
Josh Kaul	43	3	23	20	56
Eric Toney	26	0	13	13	72
September 2026					
David Crowley	75	-13	31	44	25
Tom Tiffany	84	-6	39	45	15
Josh Kaul	40	4	22	18	59
Eric Toney	23	-1	11	12	76

Marquette Law School Poll, Wisconsin surveys, Oct. 14-22, 2026, and Sept. 16-23, 2026

Question: Do you have a favorable or unfavorable opinion of [INSERT NAME] or haven't you heard enough about them yet?

Note: Name ID is the percentage that have either a favorable or unfavorable opinion of the candidate. Net favorable is the percentage favorable minus the percentage unfavorable.

From September to October, Crowley's favorable rating rose among Democrats, while his unfavorables rose among Republicans. Among independents, his favorable rating rose from 18% to 31%, while his unfavorables remained at 39%. Those lacking an opinion decreased among each group, declining most among independents, as shown in Table 10.

Table 10: Crowley favorability, by party

Among registered voters

Party ID	Favorability		
	Favorable	Unfavorable	Haven't heard enough
October			
Republican	5	81	13
Independent	31	39	30
Democrat	73	6	20
September			
Republican	3	75	21
Independent	18	39	42
Democrat	65	10	24

Marquette Law School Poll, Wisconsin surveys, Oct. 14-22, 2026, and Sept. 16-23, 2026

Question: [David Crowley] Do you have a favorable or unfavorable opinion of (INSERT NAME) or haven't you heard enough about them yet?

For Tiffany, Republicans remained 79% favorable, while the unfavorable percentage rose by 5 points and those without an opinion declined by 5 points. Democrats became slightly

more unfavorable, up 4 points to 90%, with a decrease of 4 points in those who haven't heard enough. Among independents, Tiffany's favorable rating rose 2 points and unfavorable increased 7 points, with a 6-point decrease in those lacking an opinion, as shown in Table 11.

Table 11: Tiffany favorability, by party

Among registered voters

Party ID	Favorability		
	Favorable	Unfavorable	Haven't heard enough
October			
Republican	79	12	9
Independent	20	57	23
Democrat	2	90	8
September			
Republican	79	7	14
Independent	18	50	29
Democrat	3	86	12

Marquette Law School Poll, Wisconsin surveys, Oct. 14-22, 2026, and Sept. 16-23, 2026

Question: [Tom Tiffany] Do you have a favorable or unfavorable opinion of (INSERT NAME) or haven't you heard enough about them yet?

Among registered voters, 36% say they mostly agree with Crowley's positions and proposals, while 39% mostly disagree and 25% say they haven't heard enough to say. That is a slight rise in agreement from September, with no change in disagreement.

For Tiffany, 39% mostly agree and 44% mostly disagree, with 16% unable to say. In September, 40% mostly agreed and 41% mostly disagreed.

Large majorities of Republicans agree with Tiffany and disagree with Crowley and vice versa among Democrats. Among independents, 31% mostly agree with Crowley and 22% mostly disagree, while with Tiffany 25% mostly agree and 44% mostly disagree. The results are shown in Table 12.

Table 12: Agreement with candidates, by party identification

Among registered voters

Party ID	Agree or disagree		
	Mostly agree	Mostly disagree	Haven't heard enough to say
October 2026 — Agree with Crowley			
Among all registered voters	36	39	25
Republican	4	77	18
Independent	31	22	47
Democrat	72	3	25
October 2026 — Agree with Tiffany			
Among all registered voters	39	44	16
Republican	77	7	16
Independent	25	44	31
Democrat	3	86	12
September 2026 — Agree with Crowley			
Among all registered voters	32	39	28
Republican	3	73	24
Independent	22	22	54
Democrat	68	7	25
September 2026 — Agree with Tiffany			
Among all registered voters	40	41	19
Republican	81	2	17
Independent	17	42	39
Democrat	2	83	16

Marquette Law School Poll, Wisconsin surveys, Oct. 14-22, 2026, and Sept. 16-23, 2026

Question: From what you've read or heard, do you think you mostly agree or mostly disagree with David Crowley's positions and proposals for what he would do as governor or haven't you heard enough about his positions to say?

Question: From what you've read or heard, do you think you mostly agree or mostly disagree with Tom Tiffany's positions and proposals for what he would do as governor or haven't you heard enough about his positions to say?

Tiffany is seen as supporting Trump in Congress almost always by 49%, with 38% saying he supported Trump most of the time. Thirty-two percent of Republicans say Tiffany has almost always supported Trump, compared to 49% among independents and 66% among Democrats.

Among Republicans who say Tiffany has almost always supported Trump, 82% say they are voting for Tiffany and 10% say they are voting for Crowley. Among Republicans saying Tiffany supported Trump most of the time, 94% are voting for Tiffany and 2% for Crowley.

Perceptions of Tiffany's support for Trump by party identification are shown in Table 13.

Table 13: How often Tiffany has supported Trump, by party identification

Among registered voters

Party ID	Tiffany has supported Trump			
	Almost always	Most of the time	Only some of the time	Almost never
Among all registered voters	49	38	11	1
Republican	32	51	14	0
Independent	49	27	19	2
Democrat	66	27	5	0

Marquette Law School Poll, Wisconsin survey, Oct. 14-22, 2026

Question: As a member of Congress, how much of the time has Tom Tiffany supported President Donald Trump?

Asked which candidate would do more on each of four issues, Crowley is seen as better on three and Tiffany as better on one. Crowley is seen as likely to do more on making healthcare more affordable and improving education, as well as doing a better job on data centers. Tiffany is seen as doing more to reduce taxes. These results are shown in Table 14.

Table 14: Which candidate would do more on each issue

Among registered voters

Issue	Would do more / better		
	Crowley	Tiffany	No difference
Make health care more affordable	39	23	37
Reduce taxes	17	42	40
Improve education	44	30	26
Handle data centers	32	25	42

Marquette Law School Poll, Wisconsin survey, Oct. 14-22, 2026

Question: Do you think (Tom Tiffany) or (David Crowley) would do more to make health care more affordable in Wisconsin, or would neither make any difference?

Question: Do you think (Tom Tiffany) or (David Crowley) would do more to reduce taxes in Wisconsin, or would neither make any difference?

Question: Do you think (Tom Tiffany) or (David Crowley) would do more to improve education in Wisconsin, or would neither make any difference?

Question: Do you think (Tom Tiffany) or (David Crowley) would do a better job handling the issue of data centers, or would they both be about the same?

Note: "No difference" is "neither would make a difference" for the first three items and "both about the same" for data centers.

Voters are evenly divided on Tiffany's plan to return the entire state budget surplus to taxpayers, as opposed to using the surplus to pay for state and local services. Among Republicans, 76% favor returning the surplus, while 77% of Democrats favor using it for services, as do 58% of independents. This is shown in Table 15.

Table 15: Return entire surplus or use for services, by party identification

Among registered voters; asked of half sample A

Party ID	Use of surplus	
	Return entire surplus	Use surplus to pay for state or local services
October 2026		
Among all registered voters	50	49
Republican	76	21
Independent	42	58
Democrat	23	77
September 2026		
Among all registered voters	48	52
Republican	75	25
Independent	47	53
Democrat	17	83

Marquette Law School Poll, Wisconsin surveys, Oct. 14-22, 2026, and Sept. 16-23, 2026

Question: Should the state return the entire budget surplus directly to taxpayers or use the surplus to help fund state or local services or programs?

Crowley has proposed a constitutional amendment to guarantee a right to abortion in Wisconsin, and Tiffany has proposed a 10% income tax cut for couples earning $150,000 or less and no tax on tips or overtime. Each of these proposals wins majority support. Among all registered voters, 62% favor an abortion amendment and 83% favor the proposed tax cuts.

Voters divide along party lines on an abortion amendment, with 69% of Republicans opposed, 60% of independents in favor, and 97% of Democrats in favor. In contrast, there is strong bipartisan support for the tax cuts, with 86% of Republicans, 81% of independents, and 80% of Democrats in favor. These comparisons are shown in Table 16.

Table 16: Abortion rights amendment and income tax cut, by party identification

Among registered voters; asked of half sample A

Party ID	Favor or oppose	
	Favor	Oppose
Constitutional right to abortion		
Among all registered voters	62	38
Republican	31	69
Independent	60	40
Democrat	97	3
10% income tax cut, no tax on tips and overtime		
Among all registered voters	83	17
Republican	86	14
Independent	81	19
Democrat	80	20

Marquette Law School Poll, Wisconsin survey, Oct. 14-22, 2026

Question: How much would you favor or oppose a state constitutional amendment that would guarantee a right to abortion in Wisconsin?

Question: How much would you favor or oppose a 10% income tax cut for couples earning $150,000 or less, and eliminating taxes on tips and overtime?

Voters' self-described ideology has remained fairly stable from September to October, with views of the candidates shifting only slightly, though more voters are able to place the candidates in October. Crowley is said to be very liberal by 33%, 34% say he is liberal, and 19% say he is moderate, with just 2% saying he is any kind of conservative. For Tiffany, 41% say he is very conservative, 38% say he is conservative, and 8% call him moderate, with 3% placing him on the liberal side of the scale. These views are shown in Table 17.

Table 17: Ideology of respondent and of candidates

Among registered voters

Who	Ideology					
	Very conservative	Conservative	Moderate	Liberal	Very liberal	Haven't heard enough
October 2026						
Self-placement	11	28	35	18	8	--
Crowley	1	1	19	34	33	13
Tiffany	41	38	8	1	2	9
September 2026						
Self-placement	12	27	32	17	11	--
Crowley	1	2	17	33	30	17
Tiffany	40	38	6	0	1	15

Marquette Law School Poll, Wisconsin surveys, Oct. 14-22, 2026, and Sept. 16-23, 2026

Question: In general, would you describe your political views as...

Question: In general, would you describe [candidate name] as...?

Note: "Haven't heard enough" applies to the candidate items only.

A substantial percentage describe both parties as too liberal or conservative, with 51% saying the Democratic Party is too liberal and 49% saying the Republican Party is too conservative. Thirty percent say the Democratic Party is about right, and 35% say the Republican Party is about right, as shown in Table 18.

Table 18: Are the state parties too conservative, too liberal, or about right?

Among registered voters

Party	The party is			
	Too conservative	Too moderate	Too liberal	About right for me
October 2026				
Wisconsin Democratic Party	6	13	51	30
Wisconsin Republican Party	49	10	6	35
September 2026				
Wisconsin Democratic Party	6	17	49	28
Wisconsin Republican Party	49	8	6	36

Marquette Law School Poll, Wisconsin surveys, Oct. 14-22, 2026, and Sept. 16-23, 2026

Question: As far as you are concerned, is the Democratic party in Wisconsin (too conservative), too moderate, or (too liberal) or is it about right for you?

Question: As far as you are concerned, is the Republican party in Wisconsin (too conservative), too moderate, or (too liberal) or is it about right for you?

Voters remain about evenly divided between a desire for more services with higher taxes to pay for them (47%) and a preference for fewer services from government but lower taxes (52%). This question was last asked in 2018 and, before that, 2014. Throughout 2012,

a similar small plurality favored fewer services and lower taxes until the final poll of 2012, when a small plurality began favoring more services with higher taxes, a trend that did not reverse during the single appearances in 2014 and 2018 surveys. This is shown in Table 19.

Table 19: Higher taxes and more services, or lower taxes and fewer services

Among registered voters

Poll dates	Preference	
	Prefer pay higher taxes; state gov't provide more services	Prefer pay lower taxes; state gov't provide fewer services
10/14-22/26	47	52
10/3-7/18	51	42
5/15-18/14	46	46
9/13-16/12	47	44
8/16-19/12	44	48
8/2-5/12	43	50
5/23-26/12	46	48
5/9-12/12	40	49
4/26-29/12	44	47
1/19-22/12	41	50

Marquette Law School Poll, Wisconsin surveys, latest: Oct. 14-22, 2026

Question: In general, which of the following statements do you agree with more? I'd rather pay higher taxes and have a state government that provides more services, OR I'd rather pay lower taxes and have a state government that provides fewer services.

National issues

Approval of Trump declined 1 point in October, to 37%, while disapproval rose 1 point to 61%. This is a new record low approval and record high disapproval for either the first or second Trump terms. The low for approval in the first term was 41%, and the high for disapproval was 54%.

In the second term, approval has steadily declined in each successive poll, except no change between one pair of polls, while disapproval has increased in every successive poll, as shown in Table 20.

Table 20: Trump job approval in second term

Among registered voters

Poll dates	Job approval		
	Net	Approve	Disapprove
10/14-22/26	-24	37	61
9/16-23/26	-22	38	60
8/12-20/26	-19	40	59
7/8-16/26	-18	40	58
3/11-18/26	-14	42	56
2/11-19/26	-10	44	54
10/15-22/25	-7	46	53
6/13-19/25	-5	47	52
2/19-26/25	-3	48	51

Marquette Law School Poll, Wisconsin surveys, latest: Oct. 14-22, 2026

Question: Overall, do you approve or disapprove of the way Donald Trump is handling his job as president?

From September to October, approval among Republicans slipped from 78% to 75%, with disapproval rising from 20% to 23%. Among independents, approval was unchanged at 14%, while disapproval decreased from 81% to 79%. Democratic disapproval also declined from 99% to 97%, as shown in Table 21.

Table 21: Trump approval, by party identification

Among registered voters

Party ID	Approval	
	Approve	Disapprove
October 2026		
Among all registered voters	37	61
Republican	75	23
Independent	14	79
Democrat	2	97
September 2026		
Among all registered voters	38	60
Republican	78	20
Independent	14	81
Democrat	1	99

Marquette Law School Poll, Wisconsin surveys, Oct. 14-22, 2026, and Sept. 16-23, 2026

Question: Overall, do you approve or disapprove of the way Donald Trump is handling his job as president?

Trump remains extremely popular with his MAGA base, those favorable to the Make America Great Again movement. However, the size of that MAGA base among Republicans has declined in the second term from 88% in February 2025 to 73% in October 2026, with a slip from 77% in September. Those Republicans who remain favorable to MAGA give the

president a 92% approval rating, but those not favorable to MAGA give Trump only a 27% approval and 72% disapproval, a shift of 10 points from approval in September to disapproval in October, as shown in Table 22.

Table 22: Trump approval, by party identification and MAGA favorability

Among registered voters

Party ID & MAGA	Approval	
	Approve	Disapprove
October 2026		
Among all registered voters	37	61
Republican, MAGA	92	5
Republican, Non-MAGA	27	72
Independent	14	79
Democrat	2	97
September 2026		
Among all registered voters	38	60
Republican, MAGA	90	8
Republican, Non-MAGA	37	62
Independent	14	81
Democrat	1	99

Marquette Law School Poll, Wisconsin surveys, Oct. 14-22, 2026, and Sept. 16-23, 2026

Question: Overall, do you approve or disapprove of the way Donald Trump is handling his job as president?

On Trump's tariff policies, 67% oppose new tariffs on Canada, down from 70% in September. The effect of tariffs on Wisconsin farmers is seen as quite negative, with 70% of respondents saying they hurt farmers, 8% saying they help, and 21% saying they have no effect. The trends for these two questions are shown in Table 23.

Table 23: Views of tariffs

Among registered voters; in October asked of half sample B

Response	Poll dates					
	10/14-22/26	9/16-23/26	7/8-16/26	3/11-18/26	2/11-19/26	10/15-22/25
Raise tariffs on Canadian goods						
Support	33	30	--	--	--	--
Oppose	67	70	--	--	--	--
Effect of tariffs on Wisconsin farmers						
Helping Wisconsin farmers	8	12	13	16	17	16
Hurting Wisconsin farmers	70	65	67	60	55	62
Not making much of a difference	21	22	20	24	26	20

Marquette Law School Poll, Wisconsin surveys, latest: Oct. 14-22, 2026

Question: How much do you support or oppose raising tariffs on imported goods from Canada?

Question: Do you think tariffs are helping or hurting Wisconsin farmers, or not making much of a difference either way?

Note: support and oppose combine the strongly and somewhat categories.

Deportations and immigration enforcement present a mixed picture. Asked if immigrants illegally in the United States should be deported, 55% say they favor that policy and 45% are opposed. At the beginning of Trump's second term, 61% favored such deportations.

When deportation opinion is surveyed by including in the question those who "have lived here for a number of years, have jobs and no criminal record," support declines to 43% and opposition rises to 57%. In February 2025, 50% favored and 50% opposed the policy with this wording.

Respondents are evenly divided on who they think is being deported, with 50% saying it is mostly those with criminal records and 49% saying it is mostly those with no criminal records. This division has been stable since February 2026.

Forty-one percent approve of the way Immigration and Customs Enforcement (ICE) has been enforcing immigration laws, while 59% disapprove—a slight increase in disapproval since February 2026.

These results are shown in Table 24.

Table 24: Deportation and immigration enforcement

Among registered voters; in October asked of half sample B

Response	Poll dates							
	10/14-22/26	9/16-23/26	8/12-20/26	7/8-16/26	3/11-18/26	2/11-19/26	6/13-19/25	2/19-26/25
Deport immigrants here illegally								
Favor	55	55	--	53	57	64	56	61
Oppose	45	45	--	47	43	36	43	38
Deport even if long-time residents with jobs, no record								
Favor	43	41	--	36	39	40	44	50
Oppose	57	58	--	64	60	60	56	50
Whom the U.S. is mostly deporting								
Mostly deporting immigrants with criminal records	50	49	--	--	--	50	--	--
Mostly deporting immigrants who have no criminal records	49	49	--	--	--	48	--	--
ICE enforcement of immigration laws								
Approve	41	--	43	--	--	44	--	--
Disapprove	59	--	56	--	--	56	--	--

Marquette Law School Poll, Wisconsin surveys, latest: Oct. 14-22, 2026

Question: Do you favor or oppose deporting immigrants who are living in the United States illegally back to their home countries?

Question: Do you favor or oppose deporting immigrants who are living in the United States illegally back to their home countries even if they have lived here for a number of years, have jobs and no criminal record?

Question: Do you think the U.S. is (mostly deporting immigrants with criminal records) or (mostly deporting immigrants who have no criminal records)?

Question: How much do you approve or disapprove of the way U.S. Immigration and Customs Enforcement, known as ICE, is enforcing immigration laws?

Note: favor/oppose and approve/disapprove combine the strongly and somewhat categories.

The Iran war remains unpopular, with 18% saying the United States has achieved its goals and 81% saying the goals have not been achieved. That is a slight increase from September in the percentage saying the U.S. has achieved its goals. At the same time, there has been a slight decrease since September in those that say the war has been worth the cost, with 22% saying the war has been worth the cost and 76% saying it has not been worth it. These results are shown in Table 25.

Table 25: Views of the Iran war

Among registered voters; in October asked of half sample B

Response	Poll dates			
	10/14-22/26	9/16-23/26	8/12-20/26	7/8-16/26
Achieved its goals in the war				
Has achieved its goals	18	15	14	14
Has not achieved its goals	81	83	86	85
Worth the cost				
Worth the cost	22	26	30	29
Not worth the cost	76	73	70	71

Marquette Law School Poll, Wisconsin surveys, latest: Oct. 14-22, 2026

Question: Has the U.S. achieved its goals in the Iran war?

Question: Has the Iran war been worth the cost?

Most important issues

Inflation and the cost of living remains the single most important issue for voters. The percentage listing that as the top issue rose from 45% in September to 48% in October. Immigration and border security remains in second place at 12%, followed by health insurance, and then jobs and the economy, as shown in Table 26.

Table 26: Most important issue

Among registered voters

Issue	Percent most important	Percent 2nd most important
October 2026		
Inflation and the cost of living	48	17
Illegal immigration and border security	12	10
Health insurance	8	17
Jobs and the economy	6	16
Property taxes	6	11
Public schools	5	7
Affordability of housing	4	8
Abortion policy	4	5
Data centers	4	5
Crime in your community	3	5
September 2026		
Inflation and the cost of living	45	19
Illegal immigration and border security	11	7
Health insurance	9	13
Jobs and the economy	9	16
Property taxes	7	10
Public schools	4	4
Affordability of housing	4	12
Abortion policy	5	4
Data centers	5	9
Crime in your community	2	6

Marquette Law School Poll, Wisconsin surveys, Oct. 14-22, 2026, and Sept. 16-23, 2026

Question: Which one of the following issues matters MOST to you right now?

Question: And which is the second most important issue to you right now?

Note: both blocks are ordered by the October ranking.

Views of the economy and prices

Sixteen percent say they are better off than a year ago, while 42% say they are worse off and 42% say they are about the same. The net of better off minus worse off was at +3 in early February 2026, having improved since February 2025. That improving trend reversed in March 2026 and has generally declined since March, reaching -26 in October, as shown in Table 27.

Table 27: Better or worse off than a year ago

Among registered voters

Poll dates	Better or worse off			
	Net better-worse	Better	About the same	Worse
10/14-22/26	-26	16	42	42
9/16-23/26	-27	16	41	43
8/12-20/26	-17	20	42	38
7/8-16/26	-21	18	43	39
3/11-18/26	-6	26	43	32
2/11-19/26	3	32	38	30
10/15-22/25	-3	28	42	30
2/19-26/25	-10	21	49	31

Marquette Law School Poll, Wisconsin surveys, latest: Oct. 14-22, 2026

Question: Would you say you personally are better off, about the same, or worse off than you were a year ago?

Looking ahead over the next 12 months, 70% expect inflation to increase, 11% say it will decrease, and 18% expect it to stay about the same. That is a slight improvement from September, when 74% said they expected that inflation would increase, as shown in Table 28.

Table 28: Expected inflation over the next 12 months

Among registered voters

Poll dates	Inflation will			
	Net increase-decrease	Increase	Decrease	Stay about the same
10/14-22/26	59	70	11	18
9/16-23/26	64	74	10	16
8/12-20/26	60	69	9	21

Marquette Law School Poll, Wisconsin surveys, latest: Oct. 14-22, 2026

Question: Over the next 12 months do you think inflation and the cost of living will increase, decrease or stay about the same?

The public continues to think Trump's policies will increase inflation, with 67% saying the policies will increase inflation, 19% saying they will decease inflation, and 12% saying his policies will have no effect. The net of increase minus decrease has doubled to 48 points from June 2025. The full trend is shown in Table 29.

Table 29: Effect of Trump policies on inflation

Among registered voters

Poll dates	Trump policy effect			
	Net increase-decrease	Decrease inflation	Increase inflation	Have no effect on inflation
10/14-22/26	48	19	67	12
9/16-23/26	45	20	65	14
8/12-20/26	37	23	60	16
7/8-16/26	33	26	59	14
3/11-18/26	31	28	59	12
2/11-19/26	18	35	53	11
10/15-22/25	27	30	57	12
6/13-19/25	24	31	55	12

Marquette Law School Poll, Wisconsin surveys, latest: Oct. 14-22, 2026

Question: Do you think Trump's policy proposals will decrease inflation, increase inflation, or have no effect on inflation?

Perceptions of gasoline price increases held steady from September to October, with 92% saying prices are up over the last six months. In contrast, in early February, 50% said gas prices had declined over the previous six months, as shown in Table 30.

Table 30: Change in gasoline prices

Among registered voters

Poll dates	Gas prices			
	Net gone up-gone down	Gone down	Stayed about the same	Gone up
10/14-22/26	90	2	5	92
9/16-23/26	90	2	6	92
8/12-20/26	74	7	11	81
2/11-19/26	-32	50	31	18

Marquette Law School Poll, Wisconsin surveys, latest: Oct. 14-22, 2026

Question: How has the price you pay for gasoline changed over the last six months?

Perceptions of grocery prices have also remained little-changed from September to October. Since February, more people have said they have seen increased grocery prices, as shown in Table 31.

Table 31: Change in grocery prices

Among registered voters

Poll dates	Grocery prices			
	Net gone up-gone down	Gone down	Stayed about the same	Gone up
10/14-22/26	81	4	11	85
9/16-23/26	80	4	12	84
8/12-20/26	77	4	15	81
2/11-19/26	57	11	21	68
10/15-22/25	65	11	13	76

Marquette Law School Poll, Wisconsin surveys, latest: Oct. 14-22, 2026

Question: How has the price you pay for groceries changed over the last six months?

State issues

There was a small increase from September to October in the percent who say holding down property tax increases is more important than increasing spending on public schools, with 59% now saying property taxes are more important and 40% saying school funding is more important, as shown in Table 32.

Table 32: Property taxes or school funding, by party identification

Among registered voters; asked of half sample A

Party ID	Which more important	
	Reducing property taxes	Increasing spending on public schools
October 2026		
Among all registered voters	59	40
Republican	88	12
Independent	55	42
Democrat	27	73
September 2026		
Among all registered voters	54	45
Republican	80	20
Independent	52	48
Democrat	26	74

Marquette Law School Poll, Wisconsin surveys, Oct. 14-22, 2026, and Sept. 16-23, 2026

Question: Which is more important to you: reduce property taxes or increase spending on public schools?

Forty-six percent of registered voters say their local public schools are receiving too little funding from the state, while 14% say schools get more than is needed and 39% say they get enough funding to maintain a quality education. A majority of Republicans, 56%, say schools receive enough, while 73% of Democrats say they get too little, as do 45% of independents, as shown in Table 33.

Table 33: Adequacy of state funding for local schools, by party identification

Among registered voters; asked of half sample A

Party ID	Local schools receive		
	Enough	More than needed	Too little
Among all registered voters	39	14	46
Republican	56	22	22
Independent	32	20	45
Democrat	22	4	73

Marquette Law School Poll, Wisconsin survey, Oct. 14-22, 2026

Question: Do you think your local public schools are receiving enough funding from the state to maintain quality education, receiving more funding than is needed, or receiving too little funding from the state?

Gov. Tony Evers' 400-year veto provided annual increases in per-pupil limits for schools. The public is evenly divided on this, with 46% saying it was necessary to support schools and 52% saying it means tax increases each year for centuries. Republicans overwhelmingly say it means long term tax increases, while Democrats are equally adamant that it was necessary to support schools. A slight majority of independents, 52%, say it was necessary funding for schools, while 42% say it means long-term tax increases. These results are shown in Table 34.

Table 34: Evers' 400-year veto, by party identification

Among registered voters; asked of half sample A

Party ID	Opinion of the veto	
	His veto was necessary to support public schools in the long run	His veto will mean tax increases each year for centuries
Among all registered voters	46	52
Republican	11	86
Independent	52	42
Democrat	85	15

Marquette Law School Poll, Wisconsin survey, Oct. 14-22, 2026

Question: In 2024, Governor Tony Evers used his partial veto power to change legislation to require increases in school spending limits for the next 400 years. (Supporters say this was necessary to support public schools.) (Opponents say it will require tax increases each year to provide money for spending increases.) What is your opinion of this?

Declining enrollment in public schools, and shrinking school age populations, have led to the closing or consolidation of more than 600 schools over the last 20 years. School districts and the legislature have debated how to deal with this shrinking population. Among registered voters, 63% say closing and consolidating schools is the best solution, while 36% say higher taxes and more state support should keep local schools open. While rural areas are faced with substantial pressure on school populations, 72% of rural residents favor closure and consolidation, compared to 56% of suburban residents and 64% of urban residents. Closure and consolidation is favored by 84% of Republicans, along

with 57% of independents and 43% of Democrats. These comparisons are shown in Table 35.

Table 35: Closing and consolidating schools

Among registered voters

Group	Best response to declining enrollment	
	Closing schools and consolidating is the best solution	Seek higher taxes and state support to keep local schools open
By community type		
Among all registered voters	63	36
Urban	64	35
Suburban	56	42
Rural	72	28
By party identification		
Republican	84	15
Independent	57	41
Democrat	43	56

Marquette Law School Poll, Wisconsin survey, Oct. 14-22, 2026

Question: Over the last 20 years, more than 600 public schools in Wisconsin have closed, with nearly 40 percent in small towns and rural counties, due to shrinking school age populations. Do you think closing schools and consolidating school districts is the best solution to declining enrollments, or should small districts seek higher taxes and state support in order to keep local schools open?

Data centers

Attention to the issue of data centers remains unchanged since September, with 36% hearing a lot, 57% hearing a little, and 7% hearing nothing at all about the issue. In October, Republicans, independents, and Democrats were equally likely to have heard a lot, a shift from September when Democrats had heard more, as shown in Table 36.

Table 36: How much voters have read or heard about data center construction

Among registered voters

Party ID	How much read or heard		
	A lot	A little	Nothing at all
October 2026			
Among all registered voters	36	57	7
Republican	36	57	7
Independent	35	51	14
Democrat	36	60	4
September 2026			
Among all registered voters	36	56	7
Republican	34	59	7
Independent	27	57	16
Democrat	42	53	5

Marquette Law School Poll, Wisconsin surveys, Oct. 14-22, 2026, and Sept. 16-23, 2026

Question: How much have you read or heard about the construction of data centers in Wisconsin?

The percentage saying the costs of data centers outweigh the benefits has largely stabilized since February, with 75% saying costs are greater than benefits in October. This trend is shown in Table 37.

Table 37: Benefits vs. costs of data centers

Among registered voters

Poll dates	Benefits vs. costs	
	The benefits of the data centers outweigh the costs	The costs of the data centers outweigh the benefits
10/14-22/26	24	75
9/16-23/26	25	74
8/12-20/26	21	78
7/8-16/26	22	76
3/11-18/26	30	69
2/11-19/26	29	70
10/15-22/25	44	55

Marquette Law School Poll, Wisconsin surveys, latest: Oct. 14-22, 2026

Question: There are several large data centers being proposed or under construction in Wisconsin. Which comes closer to your opinion, even if neither is exactly right:

October 2025 question: There are several large data centers being proposed or under construction in Wisconsin though Microsoft recently announced it would not build one after facing community opposition. Which comes closer to your opinion, even if neither is exactly right:

A majority of registered voters, 62%, say that Flock Safety's network of surveillance cameras is an unacceptable violation of privacy rights, while 37% say they are an important tool for police investigations. A majority of Republicans, independents, and Democrats oppose these cameras, as shown in Table 38.

Table 38: Flock Safety camera network: police tool or privacy violation

Among registered voters

Party ID	View of the camera network	
	Important tool for police investigations	Unacceptable violation of privacy rights
October 2026		
Among all registered voters	37	62
Republican	44	55
Independent	35	65
Democrat	30	69
September 2026		
Among all registered voters	37	63
Republican	52	48
Independent	27	71
Democrat	23	76

Marquette Law School Poll, Wisconsin surveys, Oct. 14-22, 2026, and Sept. 16-23, 2026

Question: Flock Safety has a network of 120,000 cameras which allow the company and law enforcement to track the movement of vehicles. Do you think these cameras are an important tool for police investigations, or an unacceptable violation of Americans' privacy rights when driving for everyday activities?

Confidence in elections

There has been a slight increase in recent months of confidence in the 2020 election in Wisconsin, as 70% in October say they are very or somewhat confident, while 30% say they are not too or not at all confident. This trend since 2022 is shown in Table 39.

Table 39: Confidence in the 2020 vote count in Wisconsin

Among registered voters; in October asked of half sample A

Poll dates	Confidence	
	Very/somewhat confident	Not too/not at all confident
10/14-22/26	70	30
9/16-23/26	64	36
8/12-20/26	68	32
4/3-10/24	64	33
1/24-31/24	66	31
10/24-11/1/22	64	32
10/3-9/22	64	33
9/6-11/22	65	34
8/10-15/22	66	32
6/14-20/22	67	33
4/19-24/22	64	35
2/22-27/22	67	31

Marquette Law School Poll, Wisconsin surveys, latest: Oct. 14-22, 2026

Question: How confident are you that, here in Wisconsin, the votes for president were accurately cast and counted in the 2020 election?

Confidence in this November's election is slightly higher, at 73%, with 27% having doubts about the upcoming election. Confidence has varied slightly during 2026, as shown in Table 40.

Table 40: Confidence in this November's vote count

Among registered voters; in October asked of half sample A

Response	Poll dates		
	10/14-22/26	9/16-23/26	3/11-18/26
Confidence in this November's count			
Very/somewhat confident	73	68	77
Not too/not at all confident	27	32	23

Marquette Law School Poll, Wisconsin surveys, latest: Oct. 14-22, 2026

Question: How confident are you that, here in Wisconsin, the votes in this November's election will be accurately cast and counted?

Approval of governor, legislature, and Wisconsin Supreme Court

Approval of Evers, the Wisconsin legislature, and the state Supreme Court is shown in Table 41, along with recent trends. Evers' approval stands at 50% in October, with 45% disapproving. The job the legislature is doing has 38% approval, with 53% disapproval, while 45% approve of the Wisconsin Supreme Court and 41% disapprove.

Table 41: Approval of Evers, the legislature, and the state Supreme Court

Among registered voters, 2025-2026

Response	Poll dates								
	10/14-22/26	9/16-23/26	8/12-20/26	7/8-16/26	3/11-18/26	2/11-19/26	10/15-22/25	6/13-19/25	2/19-26/25
Tony Evers									
Approve	50	48	50	51	47	49	50	48	49
Disapprove	45	47	45	44	47	45	45	46	44
Don't know	5	5	5	5	6	6	5	5	6
Wisconsin legislature									
Approve	38	39	37	36	39	41	39	41	38
Disapprove	53	50	50	53	48	44	50	50	49
Don't know	10	11	13	11	13	15	11	10	13
Wisconsin Supreme Court									
Approve	45	50	47	50	46	49	45	49	46
Disapprove	41	37	36	38	37	34	39	38	37
Don't know	14	13	17	12	17	16	15	13	16

Marquette Law School Poll, Wisconsin surveys, latest: Oct. 14-22, 2026

Question: Overall, do you approve or disapprove of the way Tony Evers is handling his job as Governor of Wisconsin?

Question: Overall, do you approve or disapprove of the way the Wisconsin legislature is handling its job?

Question: Overall, do you approve or disapprove of the way the Wisconsin state Supreme Court is handling its job?

Favorability of political figures and groups

Favorability of state and national political figures in October and September is shown in Table 42. As in September, Evers has the highest net favorability rating and Trump has the lowest.

Table 42: Favorability of state and national political figures

Among registered voters

Political figure	Favorability			
	Net Fav	Favorable	Unfavorable	Haven't heard enough
October 2026				
Tony Evers	4	49	45	6
Tammy Baldwin	0	45	45	10
Marco Rubio	-11	36	47	16
Ron Johnson	-13	37	50	12
JD Vance	-16	40	56	5
Pete Hegseth	-22	27	49	24
Donald Trump	-25	37	62	2
September 2026				
Tony Evers	3	48	45	6
Tammy Baldwin	-6	41	47	11
Marco Rubio	-6	38	44	18
Ron Johnson	-8	39	47	14
JD Vance	-9	43	52	5
Pete Hegseth	-20	28	48	24
Donald Trump	-22	38	60	2

Marquette Law School Poll, Wisconsin surveys, Oct. 14-22, 2026, and Sept. 16-23, 2026

Question: Do you have a favorable or unfavorable opinion of [INSERT NAME] or haven't you heard enough about them yet?

Favorability of the parties and political movements is shown in Table 43. The Democratic Party continues to have a more negative net favorability than the Republican Party, a pattern that has held throughout the year. The MAGA movement and democratic socialists are both seen quite negatively, though more people lack an opinion of democratic socialists.

Table 43: Favorability toward parties and movements

Among registered voters

Party or movement	Favorability			
	Net Fav	Favorable	Unfavorable	Haven't heard enough
October 2026				
The Democratic Party	-20	37	57	6
The Republican Party	-12	42	54	4
The MAGA movement	-23	36	59	4
Democratic socialists	-26	27	53	19
September 2026				
The Democratic Party	-21	37	58	4
The Republican Party	-12	42	54	4
The MAGA movement	-21	38	59	3
Democratic socialists	-24	28	52	19

Marquette Law School Poll, Wisconsin surveys, Oct. 14-22, 2026, and Sept. 16-23, 2026

Question: Do you have a favorable or unfavorable opinion of [INSERT NAME] or haven't you heard enough about them yet?

College sports and Wisconsin teams

With the college football season in full swing, it is easy to assume that the audience for college sports is nearly universal. While there are many intense fans, 35% of registered voters say they don't watch any college games across any sports, with another 21% who say they watch just one or two games. At the other extreme, 2% say they watch almost every game and 15% watch most games. A more casual 26% say they watch a few games.

A substantial 59% have heard nothing at all about the Protect College Sports Act, which passed the U.S. Senate recently, while 6% have heard a lot and 35% heard a little. This proposed law would regulate college athletics, including compensation to players, transfers by players to other colleges, and conference sizes, among other things.

Opinion of the importance of federal legislation to govern college sports is close to evenly divided, with 47% saying such laws are very or somewhat important and 52% saying they are not very or not at all important.

Among those with opinions, there is generally a negative view of how well the NCAA does its job governing college sports, but a large majority, 63%, say they haven't heard enough to have an opinion. The work of the NCAA is approved by 10%, while 26% disapprove.

These results are shown in Table 44.

Table 44: College sports viewing and regulation

Among registered voters

Response	Percent
Watch college sports	
Almost every game	2
Most games	15
A few games	26
Maybe one or two games	21
None	35
Heard about the Protect College Sports Act	
A lot	6
A little	35
Nothing at all	59
Importance of federal college sports law	
Very important	13
Somewhat important	34
Not very important	31
Not at all important	21
NCAA's job governing college sports	
Approve	10
Disapprove	26
Haven't heard enough	63

Marquette Law School Poll, Wisconsin survey, Oct. 14-22, 2026

Question: During their seasons, how often do you watch college sports on TV or in person?

Question: How much have you read or heard about the Protect College Sports Act that recently passed in the U.S. Senate?

Question: How important is it, if at all, for the federal government to create laws to govern college sports, including payments to players, regulate transfers between schools and limits on the number of schools in athletic conferences, such as the Big10 or SEC, among other things?

Question: Do you approve or disapprove of how the National Collegiate Athletic Association (NCAA) has done its job in governing college sports, or haven't you heard enough to say?

With the Brewers in the World Series and both the NFL and NBA seasons underway, the Marquette Law School Poll asked about preferences of fans of Wisconsin's professional teams and also other nearby professional teams. The Packers have the largest fan base, with 54% of Wisconsinites saying they are fans, another 22% saying they are casual supporters. Among the state's registered voters, 17% pay no attention to the Packers and 7% say they root against the Packers.

The Brewers trail only slightly in fandom, with 49% saying they are fans and 28% saying they are casual supporters. A slightly higher 21% say they don't pay attention and 1% say

they root against the team with the most wins in Major League Baseball in each of the last two seasons.

The Milwaukee Bucks have a smaller fan base in this survey, with 25% saying that they are fans and 36% that they are casual supporters. A plurality of 38% say they do not pay attention to the Bucks, while 1% root against the Bucks.

Teams from adjacent states are more often the object of dislike and opposition, though sizeable percentages say they pay no attention to professional teams from Illinois and Minnesota teams. Among Wisconsinites:

- The Chicago Bears have the most fans at just 5% and casual supporters at 8%, while 54% root against them.
- The Minnesota Vikings match the Bears with 54% of Wisconsinites rooting against them.
- For the Chicago Cubs, who play in the same National League division as the Brewers, 3% are fans and 10% casual supporters, while 42% root against them and 45% don't pay any attention.
- About two-thirds say they don't pay attention to the Twins or the White Sox, American League teams who don't draw as much dislike either, with about a quarter of Wisconsinites rooting against each.

These results are shown in Table 45.

Table 45: Fans of Wisconsin and neighboring professional teams

Among registered voters

Team	A fan	A casual supporter	Root against the team	Don't pay any attention
Green Bay Packers	54	22	7	17
Milwaukee Brewers	49	28	1	21
Milwaukee Bucks	25	36	1	38
Chicago Bears	5	8	54	32
Chicago Cubs	3	10	42	45
Minnesota Vikings	3	7	54	36
Minnesota Twins	2	6	25	67
Chicago White Sox	2	7	26	65

Marquette Law School Poll, Wisconsin survey, Oct. 14-22, 2026

Question: Do you consider yourself a fan of the [TEAM], a casual supporter, do you root against them, or don't you pay any attention to them?

About the Marquette Law School Poll

The Marquette Law School Poll is the most extensive statewide polling project in Wisconsin history. This survey was conducted Oct. 14-22, 2026, interviewing 818 Wisconsin registered voters, with a margin of error of +/-4.3 percentage points. For likely voters the sample size is 668, with a margin of error of +/-4.7 percentage points. To cover more subjects, some

items were asked of random half-samples of 410 and 408 registered voters, with margins of error of +/-6.1 and +/-6.1 percentage points.

Tables that show both October and September results compare this survey with the Marquette Law School Poll conducted Sept. 16-23, 2026, which interviewed 843 Wisconsin registered voters.

Half-sample A items:

- Reduce property taxes vs. increase school spending
- Return budget surplus to taxpayers vs. fund services
- Evers' 400-year partial veto
- Whether local schools receive enough state funding
- Confidence in 2020 Wisconsin vote count accuracy
- Confidence in the accuracy of this November's vote count
- Favor/oppose a state constitutional amendment guaranteeing a right to abortion
- Favor/oppose a 10% income tax cut and eliminating taxes on tips and overtime

Half-sample B items:

- Support/oppose raising tariffs on Canadian goods
- Favor/oppose deporting immigrants living in the U.S. illegally
- Favor/oppose deportation of long-resident immigrants with jobs and no criminal record
- Whether the U.S. is mostly deporting immigrants with criminal records
- Approval of how ICE is enforcing immigration laws
- Whether tariffs are helping or hurting Wisconsin farmers
- Effect of Trump policies on inflation
- US goals achieved / worth the cost in the Iran war

The survey was conducted with a hybrid sample of 613 respondents selected from the Wisconsin voter registration list and 205 selected from the SSRS Opinion Panel, a sample drawn from postal addresses across the state and invited to take part in surveys online. The interview was conducted online with 747 respondents and, for 71, by telephone with a live interviewer. Full details of the methodology are contained in the methodology statement at the link below.

The partisan makeup of the sample is 36% Republican, 32% Democratic, and 33% independent. When independents who lean to a party are counted as partisans, the sample is 46% Republican, 42% Democratic, and 13% independent. In all polls conducted in 2025 and 2026, the combined samples were 36% Republican, 32% Democratic, and 32% independent. Counting independents who lean to a party as partisans, the 2025-2026 samples were 46% Republican, 42% Democratic, and 13% independent.

The entire questionnaire, methodology statement, full results and breakdowns by demographic groups are available on the Marquette Law Poll website.

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